directorates were made system managers to interact exclusively with one project. An external fabrication wing was formed under PK Biswas, a developmental fabrication technologist of long standing, to deal with the public sector undertakings (PSUs) and private sector firms associated with the development of the missile hardware. This reduced pressure on the in-house fabrication facilities and enabled them to concentrate on jobs which could not be undertaken outside, which in fact occupied al the three shifts.

Work on Prithvi was nearing completion when we entered 1988. For the first time in the country, clustered Liquid Propel ant (LP) rocket engines with programmable total impulse were going to be used in a missile system to attain flexibility in payload range combination. Now, besides the scope and quality of the policy decisions Sundaram and I were providing to the Prithvi team, the project's success depended on creative ideas being converted into workable products and the quality and thoroughness of the team members' contribution. Saraswat with Y Gyaneshwar and P Venugopalan did a commendable job in this regard. They instil ed in their team a sense of pride and achievement. The importance of